E3 Reading – Exam Prep Lesson 1: Main points and purpose – Handouts

Handout 1A: Why was it written?

Read each text. Write one word from the box next to it. Underline the words that helped you.

describe | advise | warn | advertise | inform | instruct

	Text	Purpose
1	Thieves work on this bus route. Keep your phone and bag where you can see them.	
2	Fresh bread baked every morning. Buy two loaves and get one free this week at Sami's Bakery.	
3	If you have a cough for more than three weeks, you should see your doctor. It is also a good idea to rest and drink plenty of water.	
4	Press the green button. Wait for the beep. Then hold your card on the reader.	
5	London Fields is a large park in Hackney. It has tall trees, a cricket pitch and an outdoor swimming pool.	
6	The library will close at 1pm on Friday 13 November for staff training. It will open as normal on Saturday.	

Handout 1B: A Free Meal and a Friendly Face

1 Every Wednesday evening, a church hall in Hackney fills with the smell of cooking. This is the Well Street Community Kitchen. It opened six years ago. Volunteers cook a hot meal for anyone who wants one. You do not need to book and you do not need to pay.

2 The kitchen is run by Amina Yusuf. She started it with two friends and one large pot. Now she has a team of twenty volunteers. Some of them cook, and others serve the food or wash up. Many volunteers first came to the kitchen as guests. They wanted to give something back.

3 The food comes from local shops and markets. At the end of the day, shops often have bread, fruit and vegetables that they cannot sell. In the past, they threw this food away. Now a volunteer collects it by bicycle every Wednesday morning. The cooks never know what will arrive, so the menu is different every week.

4 About eighty people eat at the kitchen each week. Some guests live alone and come for the company. Others are new to London and want to practise their English. "I came for the soup," says one guest, Daniel, "but I stayed because of the people. I have made real friends here."

5 The kitchen always needs more help. You do not need to be a good cook. If you can spare two hours on a Wednesday, come to the hall at four o'clock and ask for Amina.

Match a heading to each paragraph. There is one extra heading.

A. Where the ingredients come from
B. How you can join the team
C. The person in charge and her helpers
D. What the kitchen is and when it happens
E. Who comes to eat, and why
F. How much the meals cost to make

Paragraph 1: ____ Paragraph 2: ____ Paragraph 3: ____ Paragraph 4: ____ Paragraph 5: ____

Handout 1C: Questions on A Free Meal and a Friendly Face

Name: _____ Date: _____

Circle A, B, C or D.

1. What is the text mainly about?
   A. A woman who learned to cook in London
   B. A weekly free dinner run by local people
   C. Shops that put good food in the bin
   D. A restaurant that is looking for customers

2. What is paragraph 3 mainly about?
   A. Why the dinners are free
   B. How the helpers travel to the hall
   C. How the kitchen gets what it cooks
   D. Which markets are the cheapest

3. The main point of paragraph 4 is that guests:
   A. visit mostly to learn a language
   B. come for more than just a meal
   C. usually arrive in large groups
   D. like soup more than other dishes

4. Why did the writer include paragraph 5?
   A. To explain how the project began
   B. To thank the cooks for their work
   C. To ask readers to give some of their time
   D. To say when dinner is served

5. The text:
   A. describes a local project
   B. advises people how to save money
   C. warns people about wasting food
   D. advertises a new café